

Elvis Mutende.

(254) 717-796059 | elvismutende@gmail.com | <https://mutende.github.io/> | Nairobi, Kenya

A Software Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing and scaling backend systems in fintech and telecom. Proven track record in building distributed systems, microservices, and high-performance APIs powering millions of transactions. Skilled in system design, integrations, and product delivery with strong leadership in mentoring and driving technical excellence.

Core expertise: Backend Engineering | Fintech Integrations | Distributed Systems | API & Microservices Architecture | System Design.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tala, Nairobi — Software Engineer

July 2022 – Present

- Designed and built Credit-as-a-Service APIs, reducing partner onboarding from months to weeks and supporting 500K+ transactions monthly.
- Spearheaded backend architecture improvements for lending products, increasing scalability and reliability across the Kenyan market.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with product and data teams to align business needs with engineering delivery.
- Mentored junior engineers, improving onboarding and code quality across the team.

Key Tech: Kotlin, Java, Spring Boot, MariaDB, Microservices, Docker, CI/CD, Kafka, Redis

Safaricom PLC, Nairobi — Financial Solutions Engineer

Sept 2021 – July 2022

- Engineered backend logic for payment products used by millions of customers.
- Digitised till & paybill onboarding process, cutting customer activation time from 3–14 days → 24 hours, driving adoption of new payment services.
- Developed robust APIs and integration flows with strict reliability & compliance requirements.

Key Tech: Java, Spring Boot, MySQL, MongoDB, APIs, CI/CD, Git, Docker, Kafka, Redis, RabbitMQ

Lanstar Technologies, Nairobi — Software Engineer

Sept 2020 – Aug 2021

- Designed and implemented CRB (Credit Reference Bureau) integration microservice for Saccos, enabling automated credit checks and loan risk assessment.
- Delivered multiple banking and Sacco system integrations, improving service automation.

Key Tech: Spring Boot, MySQL, REST APIs, Microservices, React Js

Zalego Institute, Nairobi — Web Developer & Instructor

Jul 2019 – Sept 2020

- Built web applications with Laravel and JavaScript frameworks in a team environment.
- Trained 50+ students in PHP, Laravel, and web development best practices.
- Shortlisted among the top web instructors (2020).

Key Tech: PHP, Laravel, JavaScript, MySQL

EDUCATION

BSc. Computer Science — Egerton University, Njoro (2015–2019)

KCSE — St. Paul's Amukura High School (2010–2013)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Kotlin, Python, PHP

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Laravel

Databases: SQL (MySQL, MariaDB), NoSQL (MongoDB, Firebase Realtime Database)

Concepts: Distributed Systems, Microservices, REST APIs, System Design, System Integrations

Tools: Git, Docker, CI/CD

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced Safaricom paybill onboarding time from 14 days to 24 hours.
- Delivered CRB integration microservice, reducing turnaround time for loan approvals.
- Consistently delivered scalable fintech systems impacting millions of users.